

SAUCERS, GRAVITY and MEN

By James S. Veldman

On the evening of January 2, 1958, to welcome in the new year with a muffled bang, Radio Moscow announced in a special broadcast that the scientists of the U.S.S.R. had an anti-gravity disc under development. The announcement was brief and vague and it is rather difficult to tell just what it was supposed to mean: but if we can take it at its face value (and considering the source we may have some doubts about that point) then we must consider especially the phrase "under development". This to us, connotes something in the stages of actual experimentation rather than something merely discussed or on the drawing board of some engineer. If this interpretation should prove correct it may mean that the Russians have taken the first step toward a discovery which might eclipse even that of nuclear energy.

To anyone who has followed the subject of saucers and space flight very closely the Russian announcement came as no great shock. It has been known for some time now that the governments of Russia and the United States are engaged in research to explore the possible uses of gravity (electro-magnetic) force as propulsion for future space and even atmosphere craft. In September of 1957 a rumor even circulated UFO circles that the Russians might try, through unofficial propaganda circles, to take some of the credit for the unidentified flying objects which have been seen in our skies. In October of 1957 a brief announce-

ment was carried over the American press wires of a Soviet claim concerning the possession of a high-speed, high-altitude plane shaped much like a disc or "saucer". There were no follow-up statements on this plane, or if there were any they were not carried by the press, and so it stood until the January announcement.

There is no way to know if these two announcements are actually a prelude to a Soviet attempt to call the saucers their own; we will have to wait and see. Even if such a campaign is launched there is a high probability that the public would not hear much about it, for such announcements have a habit of not showing up on radio, television or in the newspapers of our nation. For example, the January 2 broadcast was completely "blacked out" and I doubt that most people know a thing about it. Whether this is an actual example of censorship we would not care to guess, but in any case any future announcements along these lines would probably get the same treatment from the news sources.

But you may say, what difference does it make if these announcements reach the public or not? To us in the field the idea that any nation on Earth could produce the objects which have played tag with our finest aircraft and driven Air Force intelligence officers to the brink of a nervous breakdown, is several steps below the ridiculous. But to the average man on the street it may not sound quite so

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foolish. Remember that since about 1950 Air Force and other official sources have followed a policy of "What the people don't know won't hurt them". Thanks to this policy, based on a very doubtful principle, the peoples of most nations in the free world know almost nothing concerning saucer activity in their skies. True, the people behind the iron curtain know even less about it, but for the moment this does not concern us. The average American sees sightings news only when it appears in his local area and is carried by the local papers, or when we enter a "flap" of sightings as we did during November of 1957. He has no idea of the constant barrage of good reports which take place every day, nor of the complexity of the saucer situation throughout the world.

In a discussion of sightings with people who are not acquainted with our own private information sources, such as this magazine, one may often hear such comments as, "If these things are real, why don't they ever show up on radar?" or "No responsible person has ever seen them." (Guess who is responsible for that last one?). We know that there have been literally thousands of good radar sightings by well-qualified persons. We know that such men as Dr. H. Percy Wilkins (foremost expert on the moon) Prof. Clyde W. Tombaugh (discoverer of the planet Pluto) and many other men well acquainted with sky objects have made sightings: we know this but the public does not!

This confusion is not surprising. Most people see only the official "explanations" for a sighting, sometimes just the "explanation" with no details of the sighting at all. These statements ridicule and insult perfectly reliable persons who have seen strange things in the sky

and pawn off such hogwash as a weather balloon going three hundred miles per hour against the wind, or a non-existent temperature inversion, as the sight these people got so excited about. Such policies give the public the impression that the entire problem is nothing more than a large truck-load of nonsense.

You will find, if you care to do a bit of survey, that most people who do not believe in the interplanetary origin of saucers think that they are some kind of new American secret development. This group is far greater in numbers than those who accept the interplanetary answer. Already duped into thinking of the saucers as an Earthly craft, due to the lack of information to the contrary at their disposal, these people just might be fooled into thinking that the saucers might be Russian, and this might cause a bit of uneasiness in some circles, to say the least.

It is interesting to note that little more than a decade ago the governments of most of the large nations of the world went off on a similar tangent near the end of the second world war in what we like to call the "Foo-Fighter" flap.

It began in late 1944 in the skies over war-torn Europe when pilots and crewmen began returning from bombing missions with fantastic tales of red-orange lights which would fly along with their night squadrons: sometimes pacing the bombers for miles, sometimes flying circles around the finest and fastest planes of the day. When the daytime flyers began to come up with similar stories of silvery, roundish objects following them around, allied command headquarters began to get a bit nervous.

These were the times when the German V-2 was whistling through

the sky and crashing with disconcerting closeness to London. In America, Enrico Fermi and his companions were working on the perfection of the bomb which would initiate the atomic age with a splitting thunder and a light like that of the sun. On both sides rumors were flying thick and fast about unbelievable secret weapons of the enemy and the intelligence services were always busy tracking down another false lead.

In such an atmosphere it is hardly to be wondered at that reports of unknown aircraft over crucial areas were taken with some dismay. Furthermore, it was not long before similar reports began coming back to allied command from the Pacific where the war with the Japanese raged in similar shaky circumstances.

By this time someone had christened these things "Foo-Fighters" and their reputation had gone all the way back to the White House in Washington and 10 Downing Street in London. Intelligence agents were handed the problem and went to work on it. Since none of the allies had anything like the "Foos" they must be Nazi secret weapons and the allies wanted to know just what the enemy had and what it could do. They found out plenty, all of it disconcerting. The "Foos" could indeed surpass anything we had in the sky and when they were shot at they shot upward so rapidly that no estimate could even be made concerning their climbing speed. They did not find out anything however, concerning the origin of the "Foos".

When the war ended the allied forces moved into Berlin and a search of German intelligence files revealed mention of the "Foos", not as a Nazi secret weapon but as an allied device. The Nazi government had had the same kind of reports

from their pilots and had assumed that these things were American or British aircraft.

Even the finest intelligence men were fooled at first due to the very same lack of information which now is the case with regard to the man in the street. After the Ken Arnold sighting brought the saucers into the open, the government knew that they were not of this world, but most of the data necessary for this conclusion is still under wraps and so how are the people to know?

However, it is not my purpose here to debate the rationality, or lack of it in the secrecy policy. Rather let us return to the Russian announcement and what it may or may not mean.

It is almost certain that the October 1957 announcement, about the saucer shaped plane, is correct. The Russian government very probably has such a plane. We may ascertain this from the fact that when the allied forces entered Berlin the Moscow High Command grabbed off some of Adolph's finest scientists. Particularly interesting among these is a man by the name of Helmut Gottrube. Helmut was working on just such an aircraft and when he disappeared into the U.S.S.R. his fund of know-how went with him. With Dr. Gottrube working for them it is almost a certainty that the gentlemen from Red Square have a very fine vertical take-off and landing aircraft which may be able to fly at unusually high altitudes. The saucer shape is probable too for several reasons, one of which is that many experts feel that it is the best shape for hyper-sonic flight (above 12 or 15 hundred miles per hour) even with conventional power plants.

The announcement of January 2, 1958 indicates a laboratory experiment in which a disc, assumed by

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many to be metallic though there is no real reason why it could not have been wood, for example, was levitated off the ground. It is known that for some time scientists behind the iron curtain have been working on something. Is it the search for a means to control gravity or even to make an artificial gravity field?

Meanwhile, in our country, and very probably in Great Britain and Canada as well, similar projects have been in existence for a number of years. Uncle Sam is spending a large amount of man hours and tax money on trying to find out just what gravity is and though, like most things Uncle is mixed up in are surrounded by secrecy, there is some evidence that these efforts have met with some success.

One of our nation's most famous newspaper men said in his column in 1955 that he had it on good authority that a U.S. Government lab staff had achieved the levitation of a disc by means of a gravity device. This must remind you immediately of the Russian announcement of January 2, nearly two years later. If the columnist's information is correct, and it probably is, then it would appear that both governments have taken the first small step toward the true nature of space flight.

Why this new interest in gravity? Well for one thing science has now come to a point where it can seriously begin such research. We now have equipment which can make it possible to do such researches.

Even before the new interest in electro-magnetics however, many scientists had put forth the idea that such a gravity drive would be a much better means of traveling to other planets than the clumsy, noisy rocket so touted by most scientists.

But it is only within the last few

years that those in authority, those who hold the strings of the fat purses of nations, have become seriously interested in these ideas. The reason? Why it's right in front of you, printed in large letters on the cover of this magazine. That's right, it is the flying saucer!

One of the first clues we had that the saucers were something beyond our usual concept of a vehicle came on the same day that Kenneth Arnold made his historic sighting in the region of Mount Ranier. On this date, June 24th, 1947 a uranium prospector was searching the rugged region near the mountains where Arnold saw that flight of nine, silvery objects weaving in and out between the peaks. The prospector also saw similar objects, perhaps the same ones, and as they flew low over his head his compass needle began to go wild, doing a dance as if it were in the midst of a magnetic storm. At the time it meant nothing to most of us, soon it was to mean plenty.

In the hundreds of sightings which followed, the flight characteristics of the UFO began to be known. For one thing, they flew silently at high speed and very few sightings reports have mentioned sound of any kind connected with these objects. For another thing, they made right angle turns: not the rounded curve of a turn we know as a 90 degrees turn but a sharp turn with no drift to the side at all. When one sees a saucer do this it appears to be the most natural thing in the world (or out of it), but any pilot can tell you that such a turn is out of the question in any plane or rocket man has ever built. And as if all this was not enough, they have the ability to pass through our atmosphere at high speed without burning up and all of them: saucers, cigar-shaped,

spheres, all the varied kinds of UFO, appear to have an unlimited source of power.

It was these facts which led men such as Professor Herman Oberth, formerly one of Germany's foremost experts on rockets and space flight, (and now at Alabama's Red Stone Arsenal where, incidentally, he can no longer make public statements concerning saucer activity) to believe that the means of propulsion of the UFOs was a gravity field. The Professor was convinced, as are most people in saucer investigation today, that this form of propulsion would give the UFOs and perhaps someday our own space ships the freedom of the solar system and perhaps even the freedom of the stars.

So, with these things buzzing freely through our skies and making engineers and pilots shudder with the maneuvers they perform, it is no wonder at all that the great powers of the world have become vitally interested in the potentials of electro-magnetic propulsion. There can no longer be much doubt that the Soviet Union became interested in

this problem at much the same time and in the same manner as ourselves. In spite of their repeated denials of the fact, enough intelligence information has leaked out so that we know that the U.S.S.R. has had its share of saucer activity. In Canada, Project Magnet was established and working for a number of years before it was disbanded, or was it just sent underground? Nothing much was said to have come out of the project but there is no way of knowing for sure because no one here or in Canada is talking.

Even as the governments of the major nations, with the possible exception of Australia, ridicule the saucer enigma, they have already begun work on trying to steal a page right out of the extraterrestrial book. How far they have gotten no one can say, but it may be that the moon is much closer than any of us think.

Next issue I would like to discuss what the G-field concept could mean to us and to our own space travel plans and what our spaceman of the future may be flying.

THE END

U.F.O. BOOK REVIEWS

(Concluded from page 71)

know Gray from his column "Chasing the Flying Saucers" which appears each issue in FLYING SAUCERS.

Saucers have at last achieved some degree of respectability; don't let it slip away. Discuss the U.F.O. problem freely with your friends, especially with those who are anti-saucer. We need good people in this field and you can help recruit them. Buy the U.F.O. books; the knowl-

edge in them is priceless and the boys can use the royalties.

We don't care who your favorite saucer researcher is; send him all the information you run across. Most of the boys will be very grateful for it and all of us can use all the good material we can get. This is a new field we are trying to open up with these books and it isn't going to be easy.

THE END

READ OUR SISTER MAGAZINE, SEARCH, TOO!